



KBM Neurological Institute

ACCESSIBILITY POLICY

Neurology Practice / Clinic: [Practice Name]

Effective Date: [Date]

Last Updated: [Date]

Policy Version: 1.0

1. Purpose

At **[Practice Name]**, we are committed to providing an inclusive, respectful, and accessible healthcare environment for all patients, visitors, caregivers, and members of the public.

We aim to ensure that people with disabilities can access our healthcare services, facilities, website, information, and communication channels as easily and independently as reasonably possible.

2. Our Commitment

We recognise that patients may experience different types of disabilities or accessibility requirements, including:

- Visual disabilities
- Hearing disabilities
- Physical or mobility disabilities
- Cognitive disabilities
- Neurological disabilities
- Speech or communication difficulties
- Temporary disabilities
- Age-related accessibility requirements

We will make reasonable efforts to accommodate individual accessibility requirements and remove barriers to accessing our services.

3. Accessible Healthcare Services

Where reasonably possible, we aim to provide accessible healthcare services by:

- Providing reasonable assistance to patients who require support
- Allowing patients to communicate their accessibility requirements
- Providing appropriate assistance during appointments
- Supporting patients who require additional time or communication assistance
- Accommodating caregivers or authorised support persons where appropriate
- Providing accessible communication methods where available
- Making reasonable adjustments to our services based on individual needs

Patients are encouraged to inform the practice of any accessibility requirements when booking an appointment.

4. Website Accessibility

We aim to make our website accessible and easy to use for people with disabilities.

Our website is designed, where reasonably practicable, to support:

- Keyboard navigation
- Clear and consistent page layouts
- Readable text
- Appropriate headings and navigation
- Descriptive links
- Alternative text for meaningful images
- Accessible forms
- Sufficient visual contrast
- Responsive layouts for different screen sizes
- Compatibility with commonly used assistive technologies

We aim to follow recognised accessibility principles and applicable accessibility standards when developing and maintaining our website.

5. Assistive Technologies

We recognise that visitors may use assistive technologies such as:

- Screen readers
- Screen magnification software
- Speech recognition software
- Keyboard-only navigation
- Alternative input devices
- Captioning or transcription technologies

We aim to maintain compatibility with commonly used assistive technologies where reasonably possible.

6. Alternative Formats

Where practical, important information may be made available in alternative formats upon request.

Examples may include:

- Large-print documents
- Electronic documents
- Accessible digital formats
- Verbal assistance
- Other reasonable communication formats

Patients who require information in an alternative format should contact the practice.

7. Communication Accessibility

We recognise that effective communication is an important part of healthcare.

Where reasonably possible, we will consider individual communication needs, including:

- Hearing difficulties
- Speech difficulties
- Language or communication barriers
- Cognitive or neurological communication difficulties
- The need for additional explanation or processing time

Patients may request reasonable communication assistance when arranging an appointment.

8. Physical Accessibility

We aim to provide a healthcare environment that is reasonably accessible to patients with mobility requirements.

Where applicable, accessibility considerations may include:

- Accessible entrances
- Accessible parking
- Ramps or step-free access
- Accessible waiting areas
- Accessible consultation areas
- Appropriate seating
- Accessible bathroom facilities

Availability of specific facilities may vary depending on the physical premises.

Patients with specific mobility requirements are encouraged to contact the practice before attending an appointment so that appropriate arrangements can be considered.

9. Service Animals and Assistance

Where permitted by applicable law and subject to reasonable healthcare and safety requirements, assistance may be provided to patients who use service or assistance animals.

Patients are encouraged to notify the practice in advance where special arrangements may be required.

10. Reasonable Accommodation

We will consider reasonable requests for accommodation on an individual basis.

Depending on the circumstances, reasonable accommodation may include:

- Additional appointment time
- Assistance navigating the practice
- Alternative communication methods
- Accessible documents
- Assistance from a caregiver or support person
- Adjustments to appointment arrangements

Requests will be considered in accordance with applicable legal, medical, safety, and operational requirements.

11. Accessibility and Neurological Conditions

We recognise that neurological conditions may affect mobility, speech, hearing, vision, cognition, memory, concentration, or communication.

Patients are encouraged to inform our staff if a neurological condition creates a specific accessibility requirement.

Where reasonably possible, we will work with the patient and their authorised caregiver or representative to identify appropriate adjustments.

12. Accessibility Feedback

We welcome feedback from patients and website visitors regarding accessibility.

If you experience an accessibility barrier or have a suggestion for improving accessibility, please contact:

Accessibility Contact: [Name / Position]

Email: [Email Address]

Telephone: [Telephone Number]

When reporting an accessibility issue, please provide as much information as possible, including:

- The service or webpage affected
- The accessibility problem experienced
- The device or technology being used, if relevant
- Any suggested solution, if available

We will consider accessibility feedback and take reasonable steps to address identified barriers.

Absolutely. I'd add the following section to make the process clear, practical, and patient-friendly.

Accessibility Request Process

We encourage patients, caregivers, and visitors to let us know about any accessibility requirements before attending the practice or using our services. We will make reasonable efforts to accommodate requests and reduce barriers to accessing healthcare.

Step 1: Make a Request

Accessibility requests may be made:

- When booking an appointment
- Before an appointment by telephone or email
- When completing a patient registration form
- When arriving at the practice
- By a patient's authorised caregiver or representative, where appropriate

Accessibility Contact: [Name / Position]

Telephone: [Telephone Number]

Email: [Email Address]

Patients do not need to provide a medical diagnosis unless the information is necessary to understand or provide the requested accommodation.

Step 2: Tell Us What You Need

Please describe the assistance or adjustment you require. Examples include:

- Wheelchair or mobility access
- Assistance entering or navigating the practice
- Accessible parking
- Additional time for an appointment
- Assistance with forms or written information
- Large-print or electronic information
- Communication assistance
- Hearing-related accommodations
- Support for speech or communication difficulties
- Assistance relating to cognitive or neurological difficulties
- Permission for a caregiver or support person to accompany you
- Website or digital accessibility assistance

If you are unsure what accommodation would be most appropriate, please tell us about the barrier you are experiencing and we will work with you to identify a reasonable solution.

Step 3: We Review the Request

The practice will review the request and, where reasonably possible, determine what accommodation can be provided.

We may contact you if we require additional information to understand the request.

Requests will be considered individually and with appropriate regard to:

- The patient's needs
- Medical and safety requirements
- The accessibility of our facilities
- Available resources
- The nature of the service being requested

Step 4: Confirmation

Where advance notice is provided, we will endeavour to confirm the arrangements before your appointment.

If the requested accommodation cannot reasonably be provided, we will, where possible, discuss an alternative arrangement or accessible option with you.

Step 5: On the Day of Your Appointment

Please inform reception if the assistance you require has changed or if the agreed accommodation is not available.

Our staff will make reasonable efforts to resolve accessibility issues promptly.

Step 6: Feedback or Further Assistance

If your accessibility needs were not adequately addressed, please contact us so that we can review the matter.

Accessibility Contact: [Name / Position]

Telephone: [Telephone Number]

Email: [Email Address]

We welcome feedback and use accessibility concerns to improve our services.

Advance Notice

We encourage patients to make accessibility requests as early as possible, particularly where specialised arrangements, physical access requirements, alternative formats, or additional support may need to be arranged.

However, patients may request assistance at any time, including when they arrive at the practice.

Confidentiality

Accessibility requests and any personal information provided in connection with such requests will be treated confidentially and handled in accordance with our **Patient Information Policy** and applicable privacy requirements.

This can be inserted directly into the existing policy as **Section 12**, with the subsequent sections renumbered accordingly.

13. Website Limitations

Although we aim to make our website accessible, some third-party content, documents, applications, or external websites may not be fully accessible.

We cannot always control the accessibility of third-party websites or services linked from our website.

Where possible, we will seek accessible alternatives or provide assistance when a patient encounters a significant accessibility barrier.

14. Staff Awareness

Relevant staff members will be made aware of the practice's commitment to accessibility and the importance of treating patients with dignity, respect, and consideration.

Staff should take reasonable steps to assist patients who identify an accessibility requirement.

15. Privacy and Accessibility

Any accessibility information provided to the practice will be handled confidentially and in accordance with applicable privacy and data-protection requirements.

Accessibility information will only be used where reasonably necessary to provide appropriate assistance or healthcare services, or where otherwise permitted or required by law.

16. Emergency Situations

Accessibility arrangements must not prevent the practice from taking appropriate action during an emergency.

Where necessary, staff may provide reasonable assistance to help patients safely access emergency medical services or emergency care.

If you are experiencing a medical emergency, please contact the appropriate emergency medical service or attend the nearest emergency department.

17. Policy Review

This Accessibility Policy will be reviewed periodically to ensure that it remains appropriate and reflects:

- Changes in applicable legislation
- Changes to our facilities
- Changes to our website
- Advances in accessibility technology
- Patient feedback
- Changes in healthcare practices

The practice may update this policy when necessary.

18. Contact Information

[Neurology Practice Name]

Accessibility Contact: [Name / Position]

Telephone: [Telephone Number]

Email: [Email Address]

Physical Address: [Practice Address]

Website: [Website Address]

Effective Date: [Date]

Next Review Date: [Date]